

Report on HOHEPA Farm use of Flowform treated effluent

Farmer giving report Kerry Beattie, farmer from 2002 to 2006

Hohepa has a 50-year-old Biodynamic property with about 25 milking cows (mention cheeses and awards) and has a small piggery with between 3 and 15 pigs depending on the season.

Effluent from both of these stock flows into a 5000 L tank which is treated by the Flowform® Jaerna model series (50 lpm and no vortex holes) in the manner outlined in sketches and photos.

Reports from Kerry taken start of March 2010.

After the tank was treated, the material was sprayed onto paddocks by

- Spray tanker pulled by tractor
- Travelling irrigation system plugged into underground irrigation piping

After Flowform treatment was added cows could be back on paddocks within 4 days. In practice, this was only 10 to 14 days cycle but sometimes they had to get back on earlier. Soil and grass was sufficient good quality however by 4 days.

The total volume of the holding tank was run through the forms into a drop tank and from there pumped up to the holding tank again to move the liquid on into the overflow pipe into the top of the Flowform cascade.

The raw material was treated... not a secondary pond, but a sludge pond in the tank *taken from the top of the collection through overflow down through the Flowform cascade*)

The 5000 L tank filled up in 5 days, (if intense rain then in 24 hours)

After 2 to 4 hours, the sewage changed over. He sometimes ran it for up to 14 hours but did not notice a difference, changes really after the 2 to 4 hr period was reached.

He told the change in the material in the following way

- Smell - from smelly to sweet
- Colour – brown colour lightened
- Foram – lot to start with at catch areas... the bubbles became bigger and able to join up with each other
- Look – became glossy, silica-looking and mercurial quality
- Touch – sludgy shitty mass into shiny clear structure

However he noted repeatedly that clover and rye grass growth in paddocks sprayed compared to unsprayed paddocks was much better. More growth by 50mm of clover growth in a week.